

TidyTuesday Week 41

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Friday 9th October, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly segment where we gleefully smash random strangers from the FRED database together like action figures and ask, with a straight face, whether they're in love. As always, the answer is "no," but we run the numbers anyway because apparently this is what we do with our one wild and precious life. Four days, four pairings, and the usual parade of discontinued time series nobody has clicked on since 2017.

Monday kicked things off with Residential Natural Gas prices in the Middle Atlantic going head-to-head with the "Percent of Value of Loans Made Under Participation or Syndication for All Commercial and Industry Loans, Other Risk (Acceptable)" at foreign bank branches – a title so long it needs its own ZIP code. The raw regression came out swinging: an R-squared of 0.44 and a p-value of 0.001, which in polite society would get you a standing ovation. Then we detrended it and the whole thing evaporated into an R-squared of 0.02 and a p-value of basically one. In other words, two things that happened to wander in the same general direction over a few years, holding hands only because they were walking down the same hallway. Textbook trend-mirage. Chef's kiss. Dunked.

Tuesday paired bank equity ratios in the South Atlantic with the dollar-to-SDR exchange rate, which gave us a technically-significant raw p-value of 0.003 attached to a gloriously pathetic R-squared of 0.067 – explaining roughly seven percent of anything, which is the statistical equivalent of showing up to a potluck with a single grape. Detrended, it slumped to a p-value of 0.46 and gave up entirely. Wednesday, meanwhile, was the real plot twist: Hong Kong's holdings of U.S. long-term corporate bonds versus commercial carbon dioxide emissions from natural gas pipelines. The raw version was significant ($p = 0.004$), fine, whatever. But the detrended version STAYED significant ($p = 0.003$) and actually got a little stronger, flipping to a negative relationship. I am legally obligated to call this out as the rare, interesting one – the correlation that survives having its trend ripped out. Does Hong Kong's bond portfolio secretly govern American pipeline emissions? Absolutely not. Is it fun to pretend for a second? Also absolutely not, but here we are. Thursday closed us out with two discontinued bank series shrugging at each other, posting a raw p-value of 0.17 and nobody even trying.

So the scoreboard: three trend-mirages and one genuinely stubborn correlation that I promise means nothing. Let me repeat that for the people frantically reaching for a napkin to sketch a theory: these series were paired at random, there is no causal claim, no rigorous statistical finding, and no reason to believe any of this beyond "numbers sometimes wiggle together." Spurious correlation isn't the bug here – it's the entire genre. See you next week for more of it.

2 Date: 2026-10-06

Series ID: PCU2212102212101122

This series is titled Producer Price Index by Industry: Natural Gas Distribution: Residential Natural Gas for Middle Atlantic Census Division and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jun 2012=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2012-06-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: EFAOXFBNQ

This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans Made Under Participation or Syndication for All Commercial and Industry Loans, Other Risk (Acceptable), U.S. Branches and Agencies of Foreign Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2012-07-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EFAOXFBNQ	R-squared:	0.444
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.413
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	14.37
Date:	Tue, 06 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00134
Time:	17:29:15	Log-Likelihood:	-69.835
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	143.7
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	145.7
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	104.3514	21.206	4.921	0.000	59.798	148.904
value_fred_PCU2212102212101122	-0.8266	0.218	-3.790	0.001	-1.285	-0.368

Omnibus:	2.921	Durbin-Watson:	1.600
Prob(Omnibus):	0.232	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.265
Skew:	0.146	Prob(JB):	0.531
Kurtosis:	1.803	Cond. No.	1.10e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

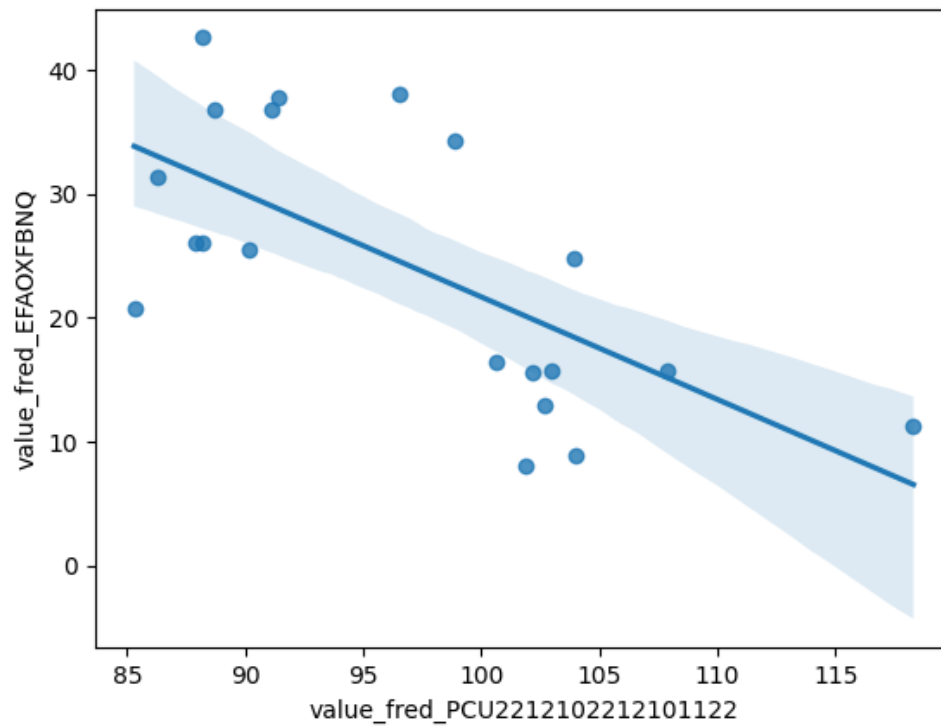


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-06

[2] The condition number is large, $1.1e+03$. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EFAOXFBNQ_detrended	R-squared:	0.019
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.035
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.3538
Date:	Tue, 06 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.559
Time:	17:29:15	Log-Likelihood:	-69.114
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	142.2
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	144.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-4.379e-12	1.807	-2.42e-12	1.000	-3.796	3.796
value_fred_PCU2212102212101122_detrended	-0.2983	0.502	-0.595	0.559	-1.352	0.755

Omnibus:	0.524	Durbin-Watson:	1.639
Prob(Omnibus):	0.770	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.580
Skew:	0.060	Prob(JB):	0.748
Kurtosis:	2.175	Cond. No.	3.60

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

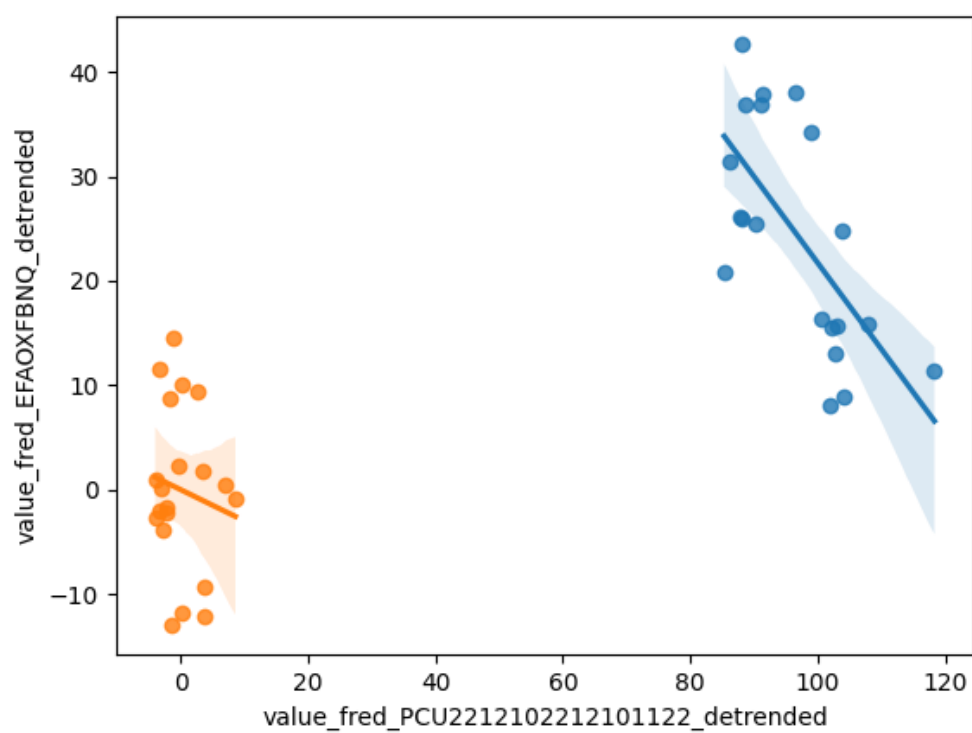


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-06

3 Date: 2026-10-07

Series ID: EQTA35

This series is titled Total Equity to Total Assets, Banks with Total Assets from \$1B to \$10B, South Atlantic Census Division (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, End of Period. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1988-01-01 and the observation end date is 2020-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: CCUSSP01IFM650N

This series is titled Currency Conversions: US Dollar Exchange Rate: Spot, End of Period: USD: National Currency for SDR and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Special Drawing Rights and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1975-01-01 and the observation end date is 2023-12-01. The popularity of this series is 13.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CCUSSP01IFM650N	R-squared:	0.067
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.060
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	9.266
Date:	Wed, 07 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00283
Time:	18:02:18	Log-Likelihood:	133.95
No. Observations:	131	AIC:	-263.9
Df Residuals:	129	BIC:	-258.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.2811	0.049	26.190	0.000	1.184	1.378
value_fred_EQTA35	0.0142	0.005	3.044	0.003	0.005	0.023

Omnibus:	3.573	Durbin-Watson:	0.175
Prob(Omnibus):	0.168	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.476
Skew:	0.161	Prob(JB):	0.290
Kurtosis:	2.409	Cond. No.	67.4

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

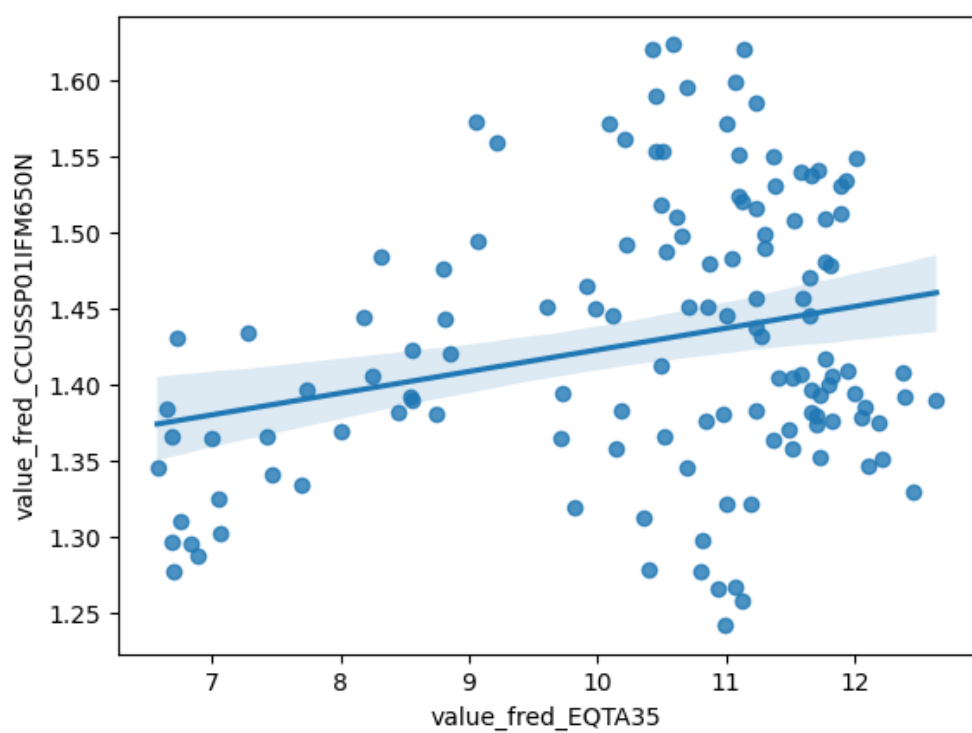


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-07

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CCUSP01IFM650N_detrended	R-squared:	0.004
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.003
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.5577
Date:	Wed, 07 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.457
Time:	18:02:18	Log-Likelihood:	139.59
No. Observations:	131	AIC:	-275.2
Df Residuals:	129	BIC:	-269.4
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	3.906e-14	0.007	5.32e-12	1.000	-0.015	0.015
value_fred_EQTA35_detrended	-0.0055	0.007	-0.747	0.457	-0.020	0.009

Omnibus:	10.155	Durbin-Watson:	0.184
Prob(Omnibus):	0.006	Jarque-Bera (JB):	4.169
Skew:	0.123	Prob(JB):	0.124
Kurtosis:	2.162	Cond. No.	1.00

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

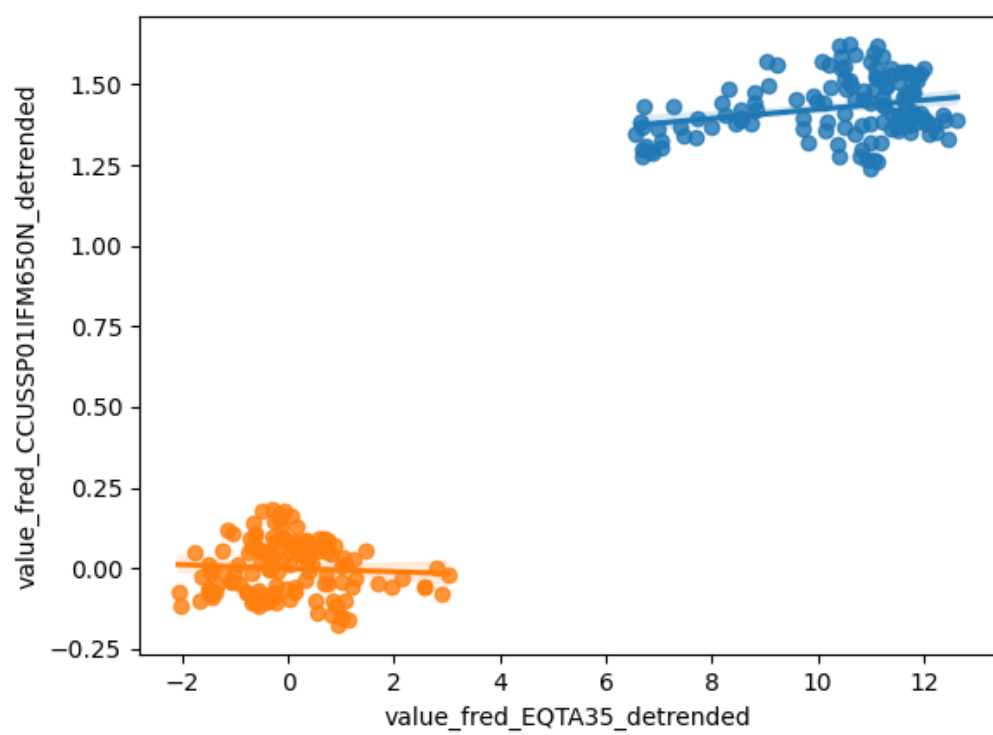


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-07

4 Date: 2026-10-08

Series ID: FORLTCORPPOS42005

This series is titled Foreign Portfolio Holdings of U.S. Long-Term Corporate Bonds: Hong Kong and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1984-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: EMISSCO2VNGCCBA

This series is titled Commercial Carbon Dioxide Emissions, Natural Gas (Pipeline) for United States (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Metric Tons CO2 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1980-01-01 and the observation end date is 2017-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EMISSCO2VNGCCBA	R-squared:	0.242
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.217
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	9.875
Date:	Thu, 08 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00367
Time:	18:03:19	Log-Likelihood:	-586.01
No. Observations:	33	AIC:	1176.
Df Residuals:	31	BIC:	1179.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

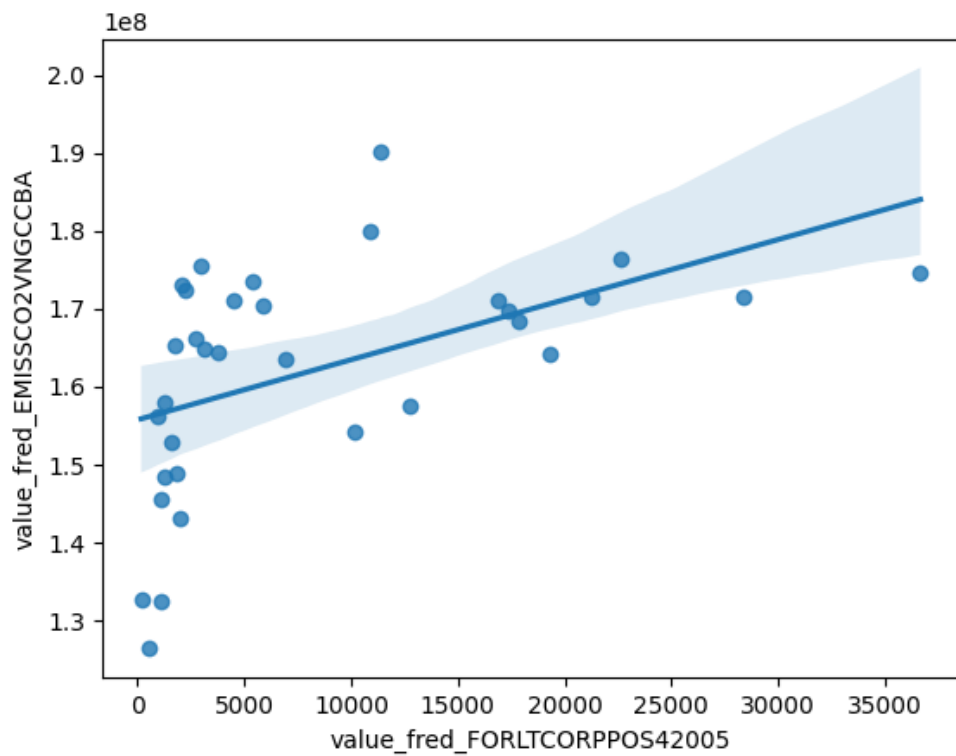
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.558e+08	3.05e+06	51.049	0.000	1.5e+08	1.62e+08
value_fred_FORLTCORPPOS42005	770.8558	245.299	3.143	0.004	270.565	1271.147

Omnibus:	0.800	Durbin-Watson:	0.469
Prob(Omnibus):	0.670	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.606
Skew:	-0.321	Prob(JB):	0.739
Kurtosis:	2.832	Cond. No.	1.69e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.69e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.



4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EMISSCO2VNGCCBA_detrended	R-squared:	0.247
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.223
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	10.18
Date:	Thu, 08 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00324
Time:	18:03:19	Log-Likelihood:	-570.19
No. Observations:	33	AIC:	1144.
Df Residuals:	31	BIC:	1147.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975
const	-1.899e-06	1.39e+06	-1.37e-12	1.000	-2.83e+06	2.83e+06
value_fred_FORLTCORPPOS42005_detrended	-895.4645	280.652	-3.191	0.003	-1467.857	-323.071

Omnibus:	5.377	Durbin-Watson:	1.047
Prob(Omnibus):	0.068	Jarque-Bera (JB):	3.796
Skew:	-0.669	Prob(JB):	0.150
Kurtosis:	3.985	Cond. No.	4.94e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 4.94e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

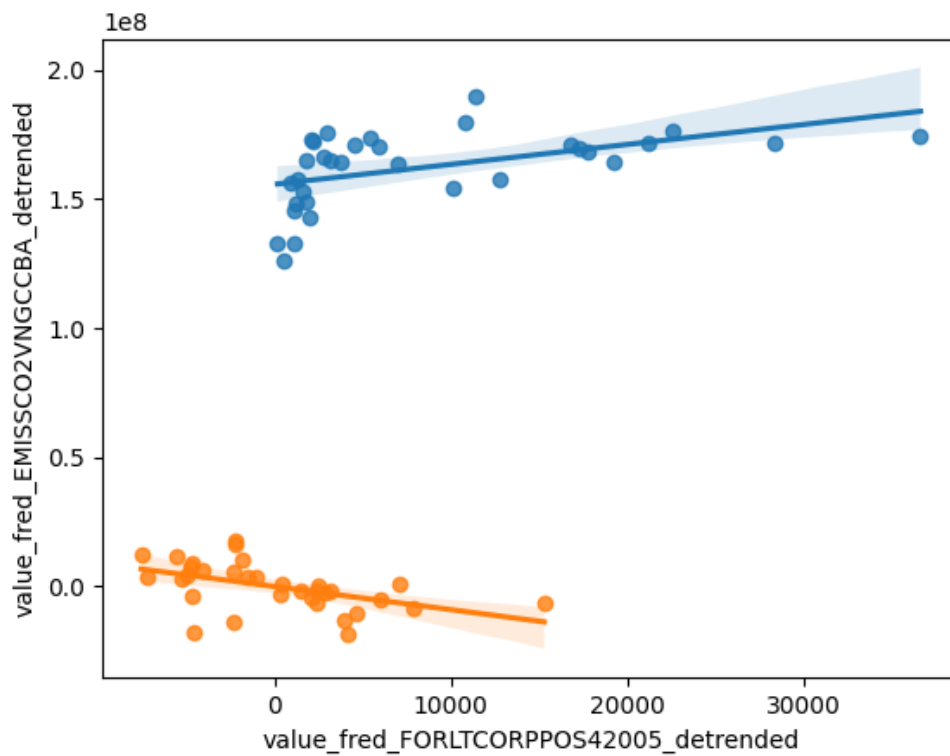


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-08

5 Date: 2026-10-09

Series ID: EBZOXSLNQ

This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans, Small Business Administration (SBA) Backed for Zero Interval, Other Risk (Acceptable), Large Domestic Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2012-07-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: EQTA25

This series is titled Total Equity to Total Assets, Banks with Total Assets from \$300M to \$1B, South Atlantic Census Division (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, End of Period. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1988-01-01 and the observation end date is 2020-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EQTA25	R-squared:	0.101
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.051
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.020
Date:	Fri, 09 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.172
Time:	17:37:27	Log-Likelihood:	-1.8044
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	7.609
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	9.600
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P > t	[0.025	0.975]
const	10.3095	0.071	145.966	0.000	10.161	10.458
value_fred_EBZOXSLNQ	-0.0676	0.048	-1.421	0.172	-0.168	0.032

Omnibus:	4.776	Durbin-Watson:	0.282
Prob(Omnibus):	0.092	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.226
Skew:	-0.525	Prob(JB):	0.329
Kurtosis:	1.747	Cond. No.	1.92

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

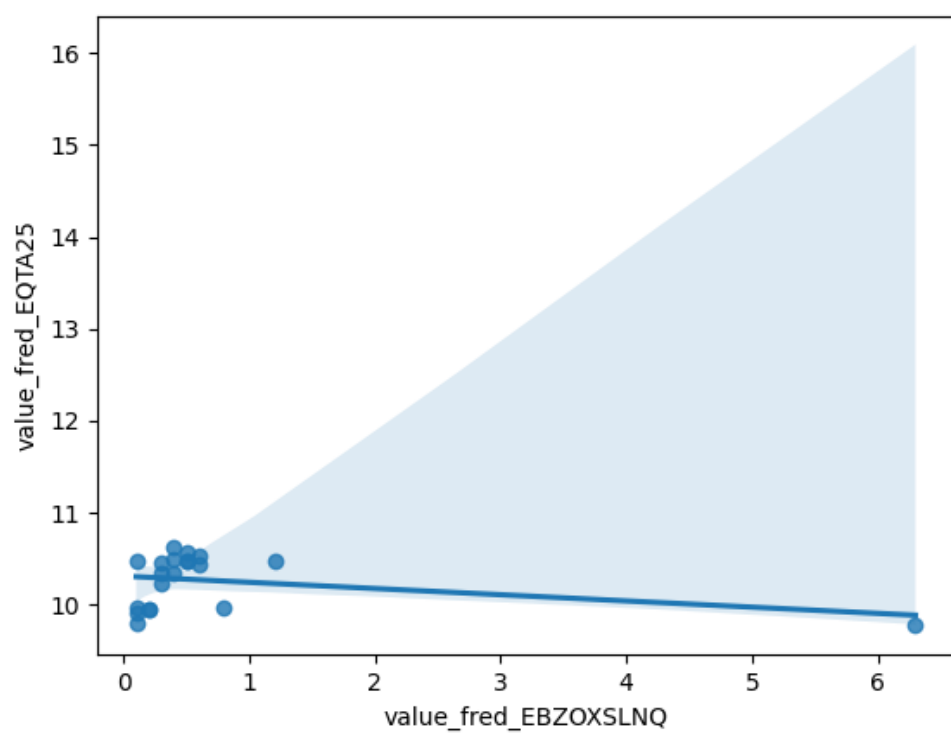


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-09

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EQTA25_detrended	R-squared:	0.090
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.039
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.777
Date:	Fri, 09 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.199
Time:	17:37:27	Log-Likelihood:	9.0990
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	-14.20
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	-12.21
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	6.819e-13	0.036	1.88e-11	1.000	-0.076	0.076
value_fred_EBZOXSLNQ_detrended	-0.0374	0.028	-1.333	0.199	-0.096	0.022

Omnibus:	3.941	Durbin-Watson:	0.613
Prob(Omnibus):	0.139	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.420
Skew:	-0.117	Prob(JB):	0.492
Kurtosis:	1.716	Cond. No.	1.29

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

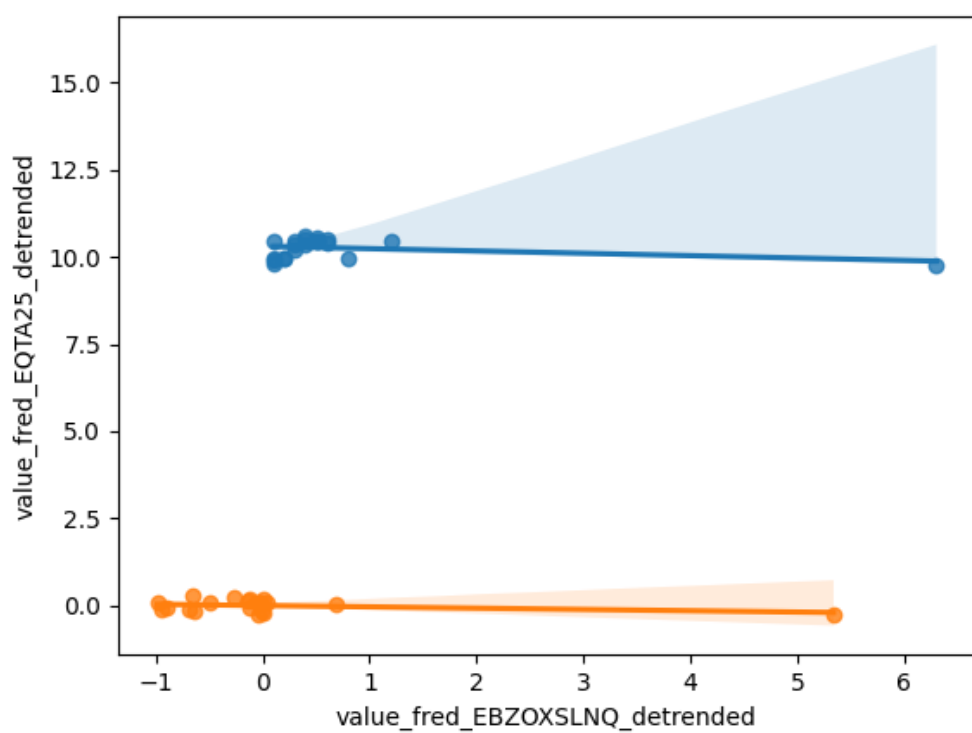


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-09